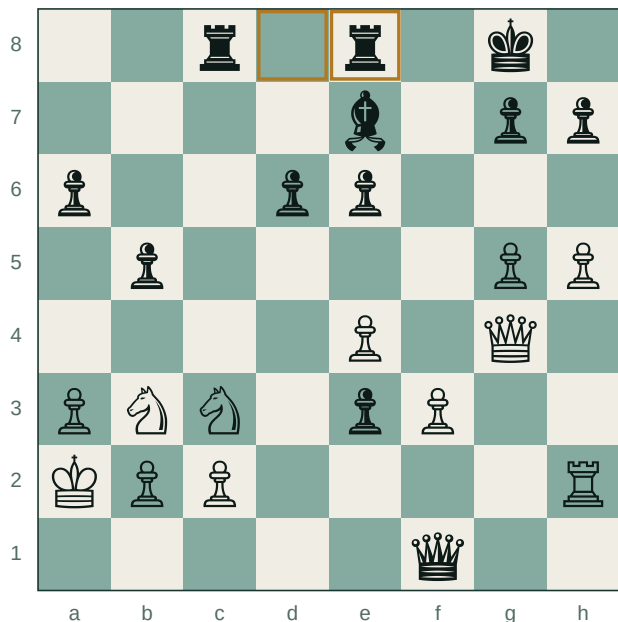


Kingside attacks: White, move 26

Kingside attacks

White to move



Previous move: 25...Re8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26. Qxe6+ Kh8 27. h6 g6 28. Qf7

26.Qxe6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From e6 it attacks king on g8, rook on c8 and bishop on e7. Recorded reply: **26...Kh8**.

27.h6 The pawn moves from h5 to h6. Recorded reply: **27...g6**.

28.Qf7 The queen moves from e6 to f7. From f7 it attacks rook on e8 and bishop on e7.

At the end, nominal material is White 27 / Black 28 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from -2 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: queen on f1. Check for tactical protection.